

What your customers see is more important than what you see. But how do you proactively identify the feelings and perceptions of the key accounts you work with?

Carrying out a Key Account Audit will enable you to proactively research exactly how your key accounts really feel and if you are simply meeting or exceeding their expectations. It will provide your organisation with specific feedback on the service your customers have received during the last 6-12 months.

The KAM audit is also a fantastic opportunity to have a face to face meeting to say "thank you for your business."

Below are some example Key Account Audit questions which were used in a real business situation by one of our own KAM clients.

PAST

Firstly, look back:

- Where are we meeting your expectations?
- Where are we exceeding your expectations?
- Where are we falling short of your expectations?
- What unresolved issues are there?
- How do we compare to others:-
 - In our industry?
 - In other industries?
- How would you sum us up in a sentence?
- If you could put the clocks back what do you think should have been done differently?
- Do you see us a supplier, friendly face or business partner?
- If we were an animal or bird what would we be?
- Overall, how many marks out of ten would you give us today?

FUTURE

Secondly, look to the future:

- How is your business changing?
- What pressures will you face from outside and inside your business?
- What will your main objectives for the future be?
- How will you achieve them?
- How could we help you?
- What one thing could we do that we are not currently doing?
- What do you see as being the big issues in our future relationship?
- What would we have to do to score ten out of ten?
- Where would you be happy to see us have more of your business in the future?
- Is there anything else I need to know...?

HOW TO USE THE QUESTIONS

- Consider the questions carefully and use them as a prompt to start thinking about what YOU should be asking your own key accounts.
- The key is to use them as a guide to develop your own set of probes in order to understand their real perceptions.

And don't forget to....

- Conduct your audits with decision makers and decision influencers individually, not together. Remember that perception is personal!
- Create a safe neutral environment so that everything that needs to get said, gets said!
- Show how much you care about their business and how much their success means to you.
- Openly discuss any identified problems! Remember they are opportunities in disguise that can be addressed and solved by your team.

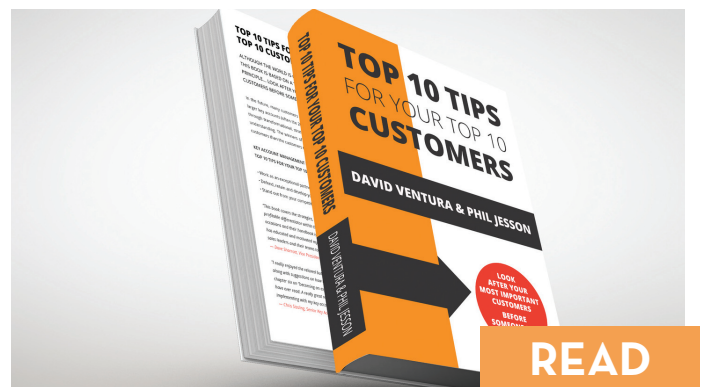
ADDITIONAL SUPPORT TO NAIL YOUR KAM AUDITS



Watch our video to bring the points to life and share with your team.



Jump on a KAMcall with us to chat through your questions.



Read Chapter 4 of our *Top 10 Tips For Your Top 10 Customers* KAM book to see exactly how 'Denis' used KAM audits in his organisation and the success that he had. The experience illustrated in the book is completely factual and based on a real West Bromwich business. It also includes practical tips on how to introduce and confirm KAM audits to your customers together with guidance on who should attend and conduct them.

Jump ahead of your competitors
with more KAM resources at:
www.kamguru.com/resources

